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Hiring Team, Upstart

Building a performance-marketing engine from zero to one is not new to me. At Plug Power I owned \$100K/month across Google Ads, Microsoft Ads, Meta and LinkedIn for multiple business units, building the pacing plans and forecasts my leadership team signed off on before a dollar moved. Bid strategy and ad-copy testing against that budget cut CPA 25%, and closing the loop through Salesforce, Adobe Analytics, GA and Google Tag Manager cut cost per lead 50% on top of it. Your posting describes standing up HELOC's acquisition engine the same way: SEM first, with paid social and display layered in once the testing framework proves out. That is the order I would build it in too.

Ambiguity is where I have spent most of my career. At Pixis I hired and managed an 8-person team running paid search, paid social and display for 8 client accounts, each carrying its own \$15K-\$90K monthly budget and its own P&L target, several in non-English markets where the playbook did not exist yet and had to be written account by account. One fashion account went from a stalled funnel to 3x ROAS in a single month once we rebuilt the shopping feed, bidding and creative together, and Amplitude and Tableau turned campaign data across 30+ accounts into the pattern that lifted portfolio ROAS 40%. Cutting client churn 50% came from treating every account like its own zero-to-one build, not a shared template.

The cross-functional half of this role is familiar too. At Sensata I ran paid and email launch campaigns for new sensing products across North America and Europe, partnering with product marketing and regional teams on messaging and channel mix so those launches drove +35% qualified leads and \$2M+ in first-year revenue, then built the SQL and GA4 frameworks that told us which cohorts to chase next. Reporting CPA, ROI and volume against a forecast, and keeping a General Manager on a strategic product line in the loop on all of it, is the operating rhythm I already run in.

What I would bring to the Performance Marketing Manager seat is someone who has already built a paid-media program from nothing, proven the testing framework with real budget on the line, and kept CPA and volume targets honest the whole way through. Proof trail at adhi-growth-ai.vercel.app/ref/upstart.

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